# HR Data Analyst technical assessment

## 1 | The management request

A fictional public agency wants to understand why it takes so long to fill open positions. Leadership has set an objective of completing onboarding in fewer than 90 calendar days after a job is first posted online. The HR team has supplied several raw system exports. Data definitions, completeness and reliability are uncertain.

*Investigate the problem, develop clear evidence-based findings, recommend practical improvements, and propose how the agency should monitor recruitment performance going forward. You may decide which analytical questions are most consequential; we do not expect you to answer every conceivable question.*

## 2 | What we know about the workflow

A hiring manager (HM), identified by administration and division, requests recruitment. HR opens the case. The HM drafts a job posting and application questions, which HR reviews and publishes. After the posting closes, HR retrieves applications, screens them and shares qualified resumes with the HM. The HM selects candidates for possible phone screenings and/or technical assessments; these optional rounds occur before final panel interviews. The HM forms the interview panel and prepares questions; HR coordinates interview scheduling. The panel recommends a candidate. HR coordinates offers, negotiation and onboarding.

A recruitment case may involve more than one posting or position and more than one candidate or offer. Not every recruitment follows every optional step. Pre-posting work matters operationally but is outside the stated 90-day outcome window. Unless justified otherwise, evaluate each completed onboarding against the case's first public posting. The file snapshot date is October 31, 2026.

## 3 | Data provided and analytical freedom

Seven synthetic CSV exports are in the Data folder: Recruitment_Cases, Posting_History, Recruitment_Activities, Applications, Candidate_Events, Offers_Onboarding, and Process_Standards. The files are deliberately presented as imperfect operational extracts. There is no authoritative data dictionary: inspect fields, infer relationships carefully, document uncertainty, and do not assume all codes or stage targets are reliable.

You may use Python, SQL, Excel, Tableau Prep, Power BI or other tools for exploration, cleaning, data preparation and calculations. A Tableau dashboard is mandatory. Your choice of preparation tools will not itself affect scoring; method quality, accuracy and reproducibility will. Please make sure your Tableau dashboard has multiple datasets as the source (instead of only one spreadsheet), and you demonstrate your data blending skills.

## 4 | Deliverables

| Item | Required evidence |
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| **A \| Tableau dashboard** | Provide ONE interactive Tableau dashboard (one or two dashboard tabs) showing recruitment outcomes and at least one actionable bottleneck view. Include meaningful filter(s) and/or parameter(s). Submit a packaged .twbx. |

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| **B \| Dashboard preview** | Export a PDF of the dashboard, so reviewers can assess the design without depending on workbook compatibility. Up to two pages. |
| **C \| Executive brief** | One-page PDF. State the principal conclusion, 2–3 quantified findings, your most important recommendation, and an important caveat/uncertainty. Write for agency executives. |
| **D \| HR + IT + methods note** | Maximum two pages PDF, with short labeled sections: (1) HR workflow actions, owners and success measures; (2) concrete IT/data quality or system-change requests; (3) calculations, assumptions, sources of uncertainty, 3–5 unanswered questions, your tools and refresh/deployment approach, and a brief AI-use disclosure. |
| **E \| Reproducible work** | Include scripts/notebooks/queries, processed analytical datasets, relevant Tableau calculated fields or brief documentation as necessary to recreate or inspect your result. Keep all source CSVs unchanged. |

## 5 | What strong work demonstrates

- A defensible unit of analysis and definition of the 90-day outcome; thoughtful handling of multiple hires and open cases.
- Evidence that data quality was investigated rather than ignored; transparent checks, exclusions and limitations.
- Meaningful comparison of process stages, teams or selection pathways with appropriate context and cautions about causality.
- Recommendations grounded in the evidence and tailored to executive, HR operations and IT audiences.
- A usable Tableau dashboard, reproducible workflow and realistic description of how a recurring Tableau Server report could be supported.

## 6 | Work conditions and software

There is no interview, live exercise, stakeholder meeting or substantive discussion before submission. Do not contact HR or IT for data definitions. When necessary information is unavailable, make and label reasonable assumptions and identify questions you would confirm after the assessment. You may consult public Tableau documentation, but no external HR datasets are required.

Free Tableau download can be found: https://www.tableau.com/products/desktop-free/download.

AI tools are permitted; disclose briefly whether and how you used them. You are responsible for validating figures and conclusions. Do not share this exercise or synthetic records on public sites, including Tableau Public. Do not include sensitive real-world employee or applicant data.

## 7 | How to submit

- Place deliverables A–E into one ZIP named FirstName_MiddleInitial_LastName_HRDataAnalyst_Tests.zip
- Upload via the confidential Box File Request: https://dcgov.app.box.com/f/c3354ae89d074ae49d726c4323c078b6. This is an upload location, not a shared folder.